

321 Make a pooter

30
MINS

Handling insects can be tricky; some can bite, pinch, or sting. A good way to collect them is to use an insect “pooter.” It works by suction, which you provide. But don’t worry—you won’t swallow any bugs!

What you need

- Glass jar • Plastic tubing • Muslin or gauze • Rubber band
- Cardboard • Pencil
- Tape • Modeling clay



1 Cut two plastic tubes: one 20 in (50 cm) long; one half that. Fix muslin over one end of the shorter tube with the rubber band.



2 Trace around the jar lid on cardboard; cut out. Make two holes. Tape the cardboard to the jar. Push the tubes into the holes and attach with clay.



3 Put the end of the long tube over a bug and suck sharply on the short tube. This will pull the bug into the jar. Study your insect—then release it.

322 Shake a tree to find bugs

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MINS

Line a baking sheet with white paper. Place the baking sheet under a shrub or tree branch, then shake the branch and see what insects tumble out.



Stick for shaking

Bugs fall out